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THE MARCODE, MILITARY ACADEMY
OF STRATEGIC AND TACTICAL DOCTRINE

TACTICAL DOCTRINE: FIELD EDITION 1.0



KEPLER

HYDRON

ERDA

LOREBOOK

PREPARED AND REVIEWED BY:
MARCODE DOCTRINE COMMAND

AUTHORIZED USERS:
OFFICER CANDIDATES, ACTIVE COMMAND STAFF, TACTICAL INSTRUCTORS

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* SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION

1-1. THE WARC CODE, MILITARY ACADEMY OF STRATEGIC AND TACTICAL DOCTRINE. The Warcode has an extensive operational history of producing combat officers. Its sole purpose is to train officers capable of acting decisively across a wide range of conditions and delivering high combat effectiveness regardless of the theatre they are placed in.

1-2. TACTICAL DOCTRINE: FIELD EDITION. This is the operational instructional publication issued to every officer candidate. It contains everything you need before taking command of a squad:

- The strategic layout of the star system, in Section 2
- The history that shaped the star system, in Section 3
- The factions active within the star system, in Sections 4 through 7
- Practical instruction for commanding a squad within that theatre, in the appendix to this publication, **THE WARC CODE TACTICAL DOCTRINE: RULEBOOK**

1-3. INFORMATION ENVIRONMENT. The information environment of this star system has been deliberately degraded over centuries of conflict. No single source provides a complete or reliable account of political history, factional motivation, or ideological position. An officer who relies on any one source, including a friendly one, will form an incomplete operational picture.

1-4. SOURCE METHODOLOGY. Political, historical, and ideological material is not presented as Warcode assessment. The Warcode does not tell you what to believe about the factions. In these sections, Tactical Doctrine provides primary source documents originating from the factions themselves. The ability to extract usable intelligence from unreliable sources and maintain clarity in a contested information environment is a core officer skill.

* SOURCE AFFILIATION:



UNAFFILIATED



DOMINIUM



PROTAGEN



MDR

* SECTION 2: THEATRE OF OPERATIONS

2-1. STAR SYSTEM STRUCTURE. The operational theatre is a single-star system. All known economic infrastructure, population centers, and military assets are distributed across its inner and outer regions. Officers must understand this theatre as a whole before engaging any part of it.

2-2. INNER ORBITS. Four planets occupy the inner system between 1.00 and 1.91 AU. Of these, only Erda at 1.00 AU supports unassisted human habitation. Kepler, Hydron, and Huoxing each present distinct operational constraints.



2-3. ERDA. Dominion controls Erda. Population approximately 50 billion. Sole naturally habitable planet. Dominion maintains orbital superiority and monopolizes space access from this position. All strategic assessments begin here.

2-4. HUOXING . MDR controls Huoxing at 1.91 AU. Colonized under sealed infrastructure. The atmosphere is carbon dioxide at 0.8 bar. MDR operational control extends outward through near space to the Cassini gas giant at 6.2 AU, with partial control over Cassini's moon system.

2-5. KIRKWOOD BELT . Primary asteroid belt, 2.5 to 3.8 AU. Industrial extraction zone. Contested by multiple factions; no single authority maintains continuous control.

2-6. ABYRON BELT . Outer debris belt, 18 to 40 AU, peak density at 22 to 30 AU. Protagen controls this region. Stations are dispersed across extreme distances, including positions outside the ecliptic plane. This complicates targeting, surveillance, and force projection.

2-7. SUMMARY . No single faction commands sufficient force to control the full theatre. This condition defines all operations.

* SECTION 3: HISTORY

3-1. CHRONOLOGICAL FRAMEWORK

Before you study history, you need to know how it's measured. All dates in this document use the standard calendar anchored to Erda:

28-hour day, 39-day month, 12-month year, 468 days per year

Year Zero is the appearance of the city of Dominion on Erda's surface. Everything before that is counted in negative years. Everything after — in the five epochs listed below. Learn them now. Every section that follows assumes you know this structure.

EPOCH 0. THE INDUSTRIAL ERA (PRE-ZERO) . Erda's indigenous industrial civilization. Multiple nation-states, analog-mechanical technology, no digital systems. Duration unconfirmed. Records fragmentary.

EPOCH 1. FOUNDATION (YEAR 0-238) . Appearance of Dominion. A single city-state of unknown origin, technologically superior, willing to trade but refusing external interference. The rest of Erda remains industrial.

EPOCH 2. THE BURNING (YEAR 238-380) . Global nuclear war among Erda's nation-states. Dominion intervenes militarily, destroys nuclear production capability, consolidates planetary control. 142 years, extraordinarily bloody.

EPOCH 3. THE GOLDEN AGE (YEAR 380-1648) . Post-war reconstruction and expansion. Dominion leads humanity into space. Colonization of planets, orbital cities, deep-space stations out to the Abyron Belt. 1,268 years of stability and growth. Longest peaceful period in recorded history.

EPOCH 4. THE BLACKOUT (YEAR 1648-2026) . Dominion enforces system-wide communications isolation. Civil war follows. Emergence of independent factions. 378 years of conflict gradually stabilizing into an armed standoff.

EPOCH 5. THE ARRIVAL (YEAR 2026, PRESENT DAY) . First confirmed contact with an external intelligence — the Ulfari. Current epoch. Consequences unfolding.

3-2. THE INDUSTRIAL ERA

At the time of Dominium's founding, humanity on Erda had reached an analog-mechanical industrial stage: heavy combustion-driven industry, electromechanical infrastructure, no digital systems. This is the baseline from which the entire theatre developed.



(“THE LONG FURNACE,” DR. EMMERICH VAEI. KOVARA UNIVERSITY PRESS.)

It was the age of molten steel and crackling radio static, of chemical plants stretching across river deltas and mines bored so deep they touched the planet's heat. Extraction and factory production had been scaled to staggering proportions — entire regions existed solely to feed the furnaces of nations. And there were hundreds of nations, each convinced its particular arrangement of power and labor was the answer to the human condition.

They competed in ideology as fiercely as in industry — monarchies against republics, collectivists against mercantilists, theocracies against secular unions — forging alliances, breaking them, warring, trading, prospering, and warring again. But what makes this period so remarkable is something that never happened: no information revolution, no microelectronics, no digital shortcut. The analog ceiling was never broken. And so, century after century of that boiling competition, hundreds of rival states, each engineering its way through the same fundamental constraints, produced a mechanical ingenuity almost impossible to catalogue.

The sheer variety of solutions they invented for the same problems remains, even now, difficult to fully comprehend.



(“LETTERS FROM THE KURSHAN FRONT,” AUTHOR UNKNOWN. ANTECHAMBER ARCHIVE.)

I'll never forget the first time I saw a real battlefield. I grew up in a small town. Sure, I'd seen machines, trucks, factory equipment, but nothing like this. I was called up to defend what they told us was social justice, and I believed it, and maybe it was.

When the order came to advance, I climbed out with everyone else. And then I saw it. Thousands of our heavy tanks rolling forward in a line that didn't end... Just steel, moving steel, all the way to both horizons. They hit the enemy trenches and just kept going, grinding over wire and earth like it was nothing. I forgot to be afraid. I actually forgot. Because above us, the whole sky was gone. Airships, dozens of them, maybe hundreds, drifting toward the enemy positions, dropping their loads, and the ground ahead just erupted. And around those giants, fighters swarmed like insects, spinning and burning and falling.

I stood there with my mouth open like a child.

3-3. EPOCH 1. FOUNDATION (YEAR 0-238)

Dominium's first confirmed appearance on Erda is dated to year 0. A single city-state, origin undetermined. Surviving records show a technological differential relative to the rest of Erda that widened, not narrowed, across this epoch. Dominion's early expansion was not conquest. It secured itself through trade and defensive alliance with its immediate neighbors, making Dominion indispensable to the states closest to it while restricting all deeper contact with the wider world. To states outside those alliances, Dominion registered as unremarkable: stable, defended, non-expansionist. Surviving records from the period show no meaningful threat assessment directed at Dominion. Attention was fixed on conflicts among other nation-states.

This is operationally relevant. Sources from this epoch consistently underestimate the scale of the technological gap Dominion already held. Read every non-Dominium account of this period with that limitation in mind.



("THE THREE-BUFFER MODEL: DOMINIUM'S SURFACE SECURITY NETWORK IN THE LATE FOUNDATION ERA," DR. TOMEK ROSETTI, LUMEN INSTITUTE OF POLITICAL HISTORY. EXCERPT, PP. 67-89.)

But what Dominion built around itself was never a simple buffer — it was a fully functioning system. Three states were bound to it through formal alliance treaties, two located directly on its borders and a third positioned at a short remove. Calling them satellites would misread the arrangement, since each received something valuable in exchange for its loyalty.

Dominium sold them military technology, though rarely anything that could be called revolutionary. These were established engineering principles refined past what any rival state could manage on its own. Engines and mechanisms ran longer and more efficiently while weighing considerably less than comparable hardware elsewhere, and armor plating held up marginally better under fire. Fuel and electricity were included on the same terms, with everything priced low enough that no ally had reason to look elsewhere.

In exchange, Dominion secured what its own territory could never supply in sufficient volume: raw mineral resources, drawn in enormous quantities from every corner of Erda. Meeting that demand required sources beyond what a single state could offer, and that is where the allies proved their worth: serving as intermediaries with the outside world, building trade chains and profiting at every link. It made them wealthy, powerful, and bound the allies to Dominion more tightly than any treaty ever could.

The conditions Dominion imposed in return were deceptively simple. Allies were expected to maintain good relations, both with Dominion and with one another, and to keep their own territories defended. Expansion beyond their own borders was expressly prohibited. The moment a state showed the faintest interest in imperialism, Dominion intervened directly in its internal politics without bothering with diplomatic formalities.

The result was exactly what the whole arrangement had been designed to achieve: the city was securely protected on the ground. As for the airspace, even if the occasional aircraft slipped past the allies' perimeters, it made no difference. No aircraft that entered Dominion's airspace ever came back out.



["COLLECTED TESTIMONIES, WORKING PERSONNEL,"
MDR CENTRAL HISTORICAL ARCHIVE, SERIES 4.]

Yeah, I drove that route for years. Same delivery, more or less, week after week.

Still never really got used to it, if I'm honest. Where I'm from, everything's got a job, you know? The roads, the bridges, the plant where I used to work before I got the truck, the rail line running through the middle of it. Everybody doing their part. It's loud, it's busy, there's ads plastered on half the buildings and trucks lined up wherever you look. I didn't mind it. It's home.

But then you cross into the City, and it's — everything's turned around. Like the whole point of it got hidden away somewhere. Nature first. Trees, gardens, that kind of thing, before anything else. The regular stuff, pipes, wires, whatever keeps a place running — it's still there, I'm sure, has to be — but it feels like it's built for you instead of the other way around. Like you're not serving the city, the city's serving you. And there are these temples, huge, go up so high you can't see the top. No idea what they're even for. Might've made more sense up close, I don't know, they never let us drive far enough in to see.

Locals, there wasn't much to it with them. You'd trade a few words unloading, sometimes one'd wander over to our side too. But it never went past small talk, they kept it at that. Polite. Pleasant, even. But there was this way they'd look at you — from above, sort of, with this little smirk. Strange feeling. And every so often, if a conversation ran a bit longer, they'd bring up their teachers or the main goal, whatever that meant to them. Like, everything they did was pointed at one thing. Us — we just lived to live. Earned, got by, pushed through. Kind of reminded me of those ideological types, up north, the fanatical ones.

3-4. THE BURNING (YEAR 238-380)

The conflict began with the first use of nuclear weapons on Erda and became the bloodiest war in human history. It engulfed every continent and nearly every nation-state on the planet. In total, the war lasted 142 years, claimed more than one billion lives, and inflicted catastrophic ecological damage from which entire regions never recovered.

You will study three distinct phases:

1. The nuclear phase (9 years), during which warheads were produced and employed at escalating rates.
2. The continental phase (56 years) of sustained large-scale conventional and asymmetric warfare across all major landmasses.
3. The attrition phase (86 years), marked by recurring regional conflicts that ignited, subsided, and reignited across devastated territories. Each phase produced different tactical conditions.

3-4-1. NUCLEAR CONFLICT (YEAR 238-247)



(HEADLINES COMPILED FROM THE KALDEN EVENING STANDARD, YEARS 234-238. ARCHIVED IN DOMINIUM CENTRAL PRESS REGISTRY.)

YEAR 234

"Kalden University Physicists Split Heavy Nucleus For The First Time"

"Fission Releases Energy Far Beyond Chemical Reactions, Scientists Confirm"

YEAR 235

"Moran Group's Classified Report Points To Self-Sustaining Chain Reaction"

"Telvara War Ministry Bans Publication On Nuclear Fission Research"

YEAR 236

"Four States Rumored To Be Racing Toward Controlled Chain Reaction"

"Industrial Capacity Shifts Nationwide Toward Uranium Enrichment"

"First Experimental Reactor Reaches Self-Sustaining Reaction — Details Withheld"

YEAR 237

"Leaked Academy Documents Warn Of Bomb With Unprecedented Destructive Power"

YEAR 238

"Navy Cordons Off Rukht Island After Night Flash Seen 300 Kilometers Away"

"VELMAR DESTROYED BY SINGLE BOMB — CASUALTIES BEYOND COUNT"



(„THE BURNING BEGINS: NUCLEAR ESCALATION ON ERDA,“ DR. ELARA SUWAN, MERIDIAN INSTITUTE FOR INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS. LECTURE TRANSCRIPT.)

The first strike was answered within a week, when the second one hit the side that launched it. Escalation followed like a snowball: nuclear activity built up slowly across the planet, and nothing could stop it. Within two years of that first strike, nearly every major power had built its own nuclear device and started using it right away. Each side aimed for the same target — the enemy's ability to keep producing bombs, hoping to strike first and gain the advantage.

Nobody held back or planned ahead, and that recklessness spared the planet a full nuclear winter. Every power moved so fast and hit so hard with the weapon that no one built up a stockpile large enough to cause that kind of damage. Production sites came under regular attack, which occasionally slowed the pace of new strikes for a stretch. But nothing stopped it, and strikes kept increasing every year.



[MEMOIR OF SEREN DAHL. RECOVERED BY THE ANTECHAMBER ARCHIVE. ESTIMATED DATE OF EVENTS: EARLY BURNING. ORIGIN: ERDA, INDUSTRIAL CITY.]

I was used to missile raids long before the nuclear crisis. Made sense since our city had a big bearing plant and some steel mills. After decades of bombing, the explosions became a part of our normal life. The air raid alarms never stopped, and shelters were everywhere, though we hardly used them. You can't just put your whole life on hold, you know? If you sat in a shelter all the time, you'd end up down there ten, twenty hours straight. And honestly, the missiles were pretty inaccurate anyway — they hit wherever they hit. Their job was either to wreck something (a plant, ideally) or just wear you down with constant alarms. During the worst spells, the big raids, sure, we'd take cover. But most of the time, we just took the risk. That became normal.

Still, you could never shake that feeling of dread. And the strange part was that the dread would actually build up during the quiet. The longer the silence went on, the closer the next raid felt. And if the silence dragged out long enough, the raid would hit harder, because they'd have built up more strength by then. And that wasn't even the worst part. The real fear was the silence during a raid itself. We called the missiles "buzz bombs" because of the sound they made. Right before it hit its target, the engine would cut out, and everything would go quiet. So if you could hear it, you were fine. But if you heard it go quiet...

All of that turned out to be nothing, though, once the nuclear bombs showed up. We got lucky at first — our city wasn't important enough, and for a long time it just passed us by. But then our turn came too. This missile made a different sound — it whistled, and it was bigger. The first one flew right over our heads and hit the far side of the city. We survived, but every window on that side blew out. The next day, one hit from the side of the city — we all saw the flash, and there was barely a whole pane of glass left anywhere. The day before, there'd still been some hope. But right then, we knew for sure — we were all done for.

The Ultimatum saved us.



**(OFFICIAL ULTIMATUM FROM DOMINIUM TO ALL NATIONS
AND OTHER ENTITIES IN POSSESSION OF WEAPONS OF
MASS DESTRUCTION. DATE AND TIME: 34.03.247, 12:00)**

Continued use of nuclear weapons will inevitably lead to the destruction of civilization on this planet.

Dominium prohibits any further use and production of weapons of mass destruction.

Dominium grants three hours from this notice for the cessation of nuclear weapons use.

Dominium grants six hours from this notice for a public declaration accepting this ultimatum.

Failure to comply with these terms will result in immediate attack from Dominium.





[**"THE DOMINIUM EMERGENCE: MILITARY ESCALATION AND PLANETARY RESPONSE," DR. HENRIK ALDER, STATION LUMEN. LECTURE SERIES, OPEN ACCESS RECORDING.**]

No one responded to the ultimatum. Not a single nation. Which was predictable, I guess, since Dominium was this small, strange, beautiful little city with all sorts of myths surrounding it. No one really saw it as a threat. But the ultimatum was carried out to the minute. Exactly six hours after Dominium issued it, nuclear facilities came under attack across the parts of the planet where night had fallen. Precise, massive, and they just kept moving through the dark as the planet turned under them. Almost none of the witnesses knew where the strike came from or how. Within a day, the nuclear war was over. And oddly enough, the conventional war stopped too. Everything went quiet. Then something happened that was genuinely extraordinary, something you wouldn't expect from us as a species — humanity actually came together. United against Dominium and its allies.

Now, you can't really say every nation turned against Dominium — that's not quite true. Plenty of states just sat on the fence, but they didn't push back either. Looking back at it now, you can basically write them out of the picture.

Dominium and its three allies came under massive pressure, on the ground and in the air. A planet hardened by centuries of war, with all its industrial muscle and logistics, moved slowly but steadily to grind down the side that had started this war against it. And then nuclear weapons showed up again — not many, but enough, now aimed at one small patch of land.

And yet, with everything being thrown at Dominium, it still managed to intercept every attack. But once missiles started launching from the front line straight at the City, they had to be shot down over allied land, flying low. This is roughly the point, by the way, where Dominium's own weapons started appearing. First, their missiles — small, incredibly fast, and, above all, they could maneuver. In an age with no microelectronics at all, witnesses just couldn't wrap their heads around a missile "thinking" for itself and chasing a target. Second, the aircraft — a totally different shape, flying at incredible speed and height, launching those "thinking" missiles.

Eventually, the opposition figured out how to launch nuclear missiles from their own trenches, timed to go off in twenty, thirty seconds. It was basically a suicide move. The warhead would detonate close to their own lines, taking out both sides — their own positions and the enemy's, though mostly the enemy's. And that's how this new phase of the war kicked off.



(THE MANIFEST OF DOMINIUM)

•

By the will of Life itself, which moves through all things and shelters the children of Erda from the endless dark and the chaos beyond —

••

We, Guardians of Humanity, Rulers of Dominion, Protectors of Erda and all who draw breath upon her soil —

•••

— seeing the civilization of Erda stand at the threshold of darkness, its nations consumed by the fires they themselves have lit, the works of generations turned to ash in the hands of those who built them, and knowing that no power among its peoples has proven equal to halting the fall —

we act. Not to conquer, but to save. Not for ambition, but for duty. What we claim here, we claim only to shield Life from the shadow, and to lead it back toward the light.

••••

Let it be known and let it be obeyed:

FIRST . From this moment forward, all inhabitants of Erda are recognized as subjects of the Rulers of Dominion and shall live under their protection and their authority.

SECOND . All nations shall remain within their present borders as they stand on this day. No boundary shall be altered, no territory claimed, no expansion undertaken.

THIRD . All nations and all military formations of any kind shall lay down their arms immediately and without condition.

FOURTH . A representative of every sovereign state shall journey to the Great Temple, and there bear witness to their allegiance to the Father and the Mother of Dominion.

•••••

No punishment shall be rendered for any act committed before the proclamation of this Manifest. The past is sealed. What was done in darkness and desperation shall not be revisited upon those who now choose the light.

But let none mistake mercy for weakness. Those who refuse this Manifest, those who cling to war when peace is offered, those who defy the outstretched hand shall be met with force absolute and without reprieve.

THE FATHER AND THE MOTHER OF DOMINIUM
05.11.248 — 12:00

3-4-2. SUBJUGATION (YEAR 247-303)



(“DOMINIUM’S DRIP-FEED: WHY THE BURNING LASTED,” KAYL VOSS, MDR INDEPENDENT ANALYST, BLOG POST, HUOXING OPEN NETWORK.)

Dominium made a major strategic error, feeding technology to their allies drop by drop. They should have committed everything at once and handed the allies weapons that outclassed the enemy completely from day one. Feeding out technology in small doses never got Dominium a fast, decisive result. It only nudged the allies' position forward, a little at a time, while the enemy adapted around it.

Most importantly, handing out the technology that exceeds what the allies could develop on their own would practically be magic to them — unreachable and impossible to copy. Instead, by releasing low-level technology that ended up in the hands of both allies and enemies, Dominium gave the opposition a reason to study it.

The enemy took the technology apart, trying to copy it. Some of it worked. Some of it didn't. But even where they failed, they learned one thing: it was, in fact, possible.

Dominium should never have underestimated the enemy's ability to learn. This opposition was resourceful and motivated. Yes, they were always a step behind in equipment, but they excelled in numbers, fought for their own survival, and drew hope from every piece of technology they managed to reverse-engineer. That hope kept them adapting. And that is why this war lasted as long as it did.





(**"DOMINIUM RESOURCE CONSTRAINTS AND ALLIANCE DEPENDENCY," VAN KHARA, PROTAGEN DEFENSE ANALYST. THE SIGNAL, STRATEGIC COMMENTARY SERIES.**)

From what we can tell, Dominion's own resources were fairly limited, even with its technological lead. That's most likely why it fought through allies instead of producing everything itself. Giving those allies the tools to build higher-tier weapons meant giving away the technology behind them. Producing at that scale in-house wasn't safer either — a workforce that large leaks information no matter how tightly it's controlled.

That left one option: release the technology slowly, knowing some of it would reach the opposition anyway. But Dominion was also confident it would always stay a step ahead, and that this edge alone would eventually win the war for them. Plus, judging by what came later, they were already planning to develop science and society across the entire planet, so losing some technology along the way didn't concern them, as long as they still expected to come out on top in the end.



(**JOREN HALE, MILITARY TECHNOLOGY RESEARCHER. PERSONAL BLOG, STATION KORRIN-7.**)

The era of Dominion's conquest of the whole planet was, without question, the strangest period in the entire history of combat technology. Try picturing it: industrial-age weapons bolted onto systems from a completely different technological world, mashed together into things that shouldn't have worked at all.

Massive diesel tanks, absurdly oversized, guided by AI targeting systems. Commanders working off paper maps standing next to soldiers running battle tablets. Flamethrowers next to thermal assault visors. Infantry in wool greatcoats, sighting through neural-network scopes. Bayonet fighting in the trenches, while delivery robots ran ammunition up the line. Artillery that was practically primitive, aimed using satellite targeting data.

It was a wild time, honestly. Nothing in the manuals applied anymore. You had to read the situation on the spot, based on whatever gear each side was using.

3-4-3. THE PACIFICATION (YEAR 303-380)



(**"THE LONG SURRENDER: ERDA'S PATH FROM MANIFEST TO STABILITY," DR. LORCAN NOWAK. MERIDIAN INSTITUTE FOR INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS, HISTORICAL MONOGRAPH SERIES.**)

It was officially announced that every state without exception had sworn loyalty to Dominion by year 303, fifty-six years after the Manifest was issued.

This should have marked the start of peace, but it didn't. No state openly opposed Dominion's authority any longer — compliance, in fact, was widespread and largely willing. Yet conflicts between states continued to flare up regularly, each side insisting it was in the right, and every intervention carried out in the name of the Supreme Authority produced still greater casualties and destruction.

Historians generally date the onset of peace and order to the year 380, when the last regional conflict ended, and no further conflict of that kind occurred again.



(**"WHY DOMINIUM LET THEM BURN," DR. MAREN REIS, MOD HISTORIAN. INDEPENDENT COMMENTARY, HUOXING.**)

I think the era of regional wars after Dominion locked down control says everything you need to know about how inhuman their rule really was. They had more than enough power and resources to shut every single one of these conflicts down before it started. They could have leaned on political pressure and influence at the earliest stage.

They could have hit warring factions with preemptive strikes before those factions even finished mobilizing their forces. They could have saved millions of lives. They just didn't. They let people slaughter each other, and only stepped in with a third party to "clean up" once the conflict had already run its course, killing thousands more in the process. That blood is on their hands.



(**PREFECT-CLERIC DAMIAN SAEL, DOMINIUM. PUBLIC SERMON.**)

At that time, humanity was not yet ready for peace and prosperity. They had to ripen first. They had to pass through the bottleneck on the way to harmony, and everyone who hungered endlessly for war received it in full. Creation cannot be given to people — it must be reached. We extended our hand to every nation, but those who chose to walk toward chaos had to walk that path to its end. It took almost a century for a new generation to rise, one that thought otherwise.

3-5. THE GOLDEN AGE (YEAR 380-1648)

After Dominium won the war for full control of Erda, centuries of growth and stability followed. The Father and the Mother of Dominium became the planet's supreme authority, acting as guarantor of planetary order. They functioned as a structure above any single nation, serving other states at once as teacher, arbiter, and enforcer.

This epoch is the longest in recorded history. It was during this period that humanity made the leap in technological development from the industrial era to the full settlement and colonization of the entire star system.



("FREEDOM TO LEAVE: THE LAW THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING," WINNING ENTRY, ERDA PUBLIC ESSAY CONTEST, YEAR 2881. AMATEUR HISTORIAN.)

The Father and the Mother forbade nations from waging war during this period, which really meant they'd lost their usual way of competing with each other.

But there was a second rule that mattered just as much, even though it sounds minor on the surface: no country was allowed to stop its people from leaving. So a country could still run itself badly: poor living standards, corrupt or incompetent leadership, no real justice system, take your pick. What it couldn't do was trap its own people inside.

Give that a few centuries, and most nations stopped being players on the planetary stage at all. They just became places — somewhere worth living and working, or somewhere people left.

If you ask me, that's the best thing that ever happened to humanity. Once governments couldn't wage war or hold people hostage anymore, they were finally forced to do the one job they were supposed to do all along: make life livable for the people in their care. It's like someone reached in and pulled their teeth out. Some governments were better at it than others, obviously. But over enough time, the ones that couldn't get it together just faded out of relevance.



(MOST UPVOTED REBUTTAL UNDER "FREEDOM TO LEAVE: THE LAW THAT CHANGED EVERYTHING," YEAR 2881. USER: YOUR_FRIENDLY_CORPORATION.)

The real players shaping politics and economics weren't nations anymore — they were corporations, operating without borders. Sure, some countries stayed closed off, self-sufficient, running strong closed economies or, just as often, weak ones. But across the board, in a world built on globalization and open markets, corporations were the sharks. This was an era of corporate wars, lobbying, backroom deals.

An era where people, more often than not, became nothing more than cogs in some massive corporate machine, left with no one to appeal to when things went wrong.



(“DOMINIUM’S CRYOGENIC MONARCHY,” DR. GIANNA MONTAYA, PROTAGEN HISTORIAN. LECTURE TRANSCRIPT.)

Dominium was ruled directly by the Father and the Mother for the first 117 years of this period — the same two who'd taken the oath of loyalty from every nation's representatives. After that, they started going into cryosleep to make their reign last longer, following a fixed 50-year cycle each time. While they slept, they left behind stand-ins, a young man and woman treated as living images of the Father and the Mother, ruling by their will in their absence.



(RECOLLECTION OF THE SED FESTIVAL. JORIN HALTE, BRIDGE ENGINEER, ERDA. FAMILY ARCHIVE VIDEO, TRANSCRIPTION.)

I guess most people dream of seeing the capital at least once. I got lucky, though — I made it to the Sed Festival, which only happens once every fifty years. There's nothing else like it.

The whole city filled up with flags, with languages from everywhere, with people who don't look anything alike. It's the happiest I've ever been. I've never felt that kind of unity before or since, with myself, with every person in Dominium, with the whole planet at once. That feeling never really left me.

The Sed Festival opened with the ceremony of the Father and the Mother waking from cryosleep. An aging man and woman opened the sarcophagi and carried out the awakening. Formally, these were just the representatives who'd embodied the Father and the Mother for the past 50 years, but not to me. My whole life, these were the faces I prayed to, the image that carried me through the darkest times. And now, right in front of me, two pairs of the Father and the Mother stood at once. I was happy. I cried from happiness.

A few days later, the awakened Father and Mother held a ceremony to appoint their future representatives — a young couple who would rule for the next 50 years. I stood with everyone else in the square before the main temple when all three pairs appeared before us at once: the Dusk Father and Mother, the Father and Mother, and the Dawn Father and Mother. The crowd roared, cried, and laughed. We were one, and I felt the kind of care and safety that parents give their children.

After that came the ceremonies: representatives from every nation renewed their oath of loyalty to the Father and the Mother, an Executive Council was appointed to help the Dawn Father and Mother carry the burden of ruling humanity, and the Dusk Father and Mother were escorted to rest, with full honors.

The festival ended when the Father and the Mother went into cryosleep. The moment the sarcophagi closed again, the Dawn Father and Mother started being called simply the Father and the Mother. For the next 50 years, it would be them looking after and guiding us.



(“DOMINIUM CLAN-OLIGARCHIC MODEL DURING THE GOLDEN AGE,” PROTAGEN SCIENCE DIRECTORATE. RESEARCH FRAMEWORK DOCUMENT.)

Dominium's governance structure during this period functioned as a clan-oligarchic system, archaic by any reasonable classification. Outside entry was structurally excluded, and the existing power base reinforced itself by design. Beneath the ceremonial display of the Sed Festival, the actual function was elite consolidation: family lines presenting their heirs to the Father and the Mother, and to each other. Spheres of influence and interest were redistributed or reaffirmed in the process.



(“EMOTIONAL UNIFORMITY IN SED FESTIVAL TESTIMONY,” DR. MEERA KMITKA, MDR PSYCHOLOGIST. REPUBLIC INSTITUTE OF HUMAN SCIENCES.)

The available testimony on the ceremony shows an unusually uniform emotional response. Subjects report the full spectrum, from grief to elation, and the standard explanation is situational: the weight of the event, the setting, festival atmosphere. That explanation doesn't hold up under closer review.

First, negative affect is essentially absent from the record. Censorship could account for some of that, along with a natural survivorship bias toward sources that describe the festival favorably. I reviewed all 23 documented occurrences and every source I could access. Not one mentions so much as physical fatigue, despite days of ceremony that, by any normal measure, should have produced it.

Second, the emotional profile itself is nearly identical across subjects, regardless of background, origin, or prior disposition toward Dominium.

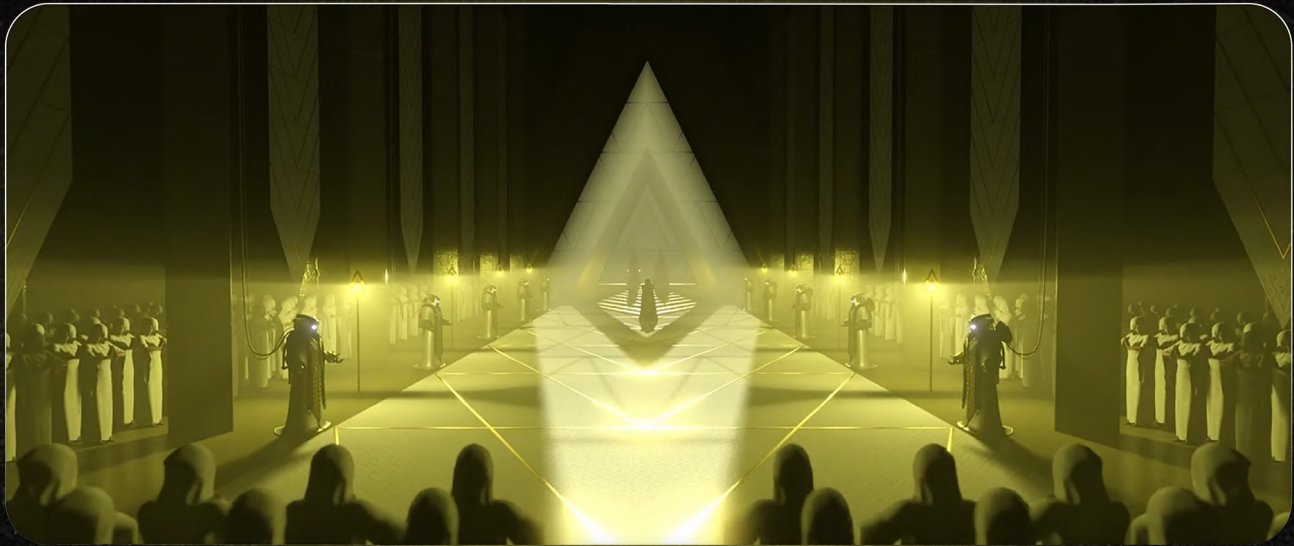
Third, the duration is what should concern us. Every documented attendee carried the same sense of awe and unity for the rest of their life, with no measurable decline over time. That is not how memory or emotion normally behaves.

Any one of these findings could be explained away individually. A sample this size, with this little variance and zero exceptions, cannot. Draw your own conclusions.



(“LEGACY TALKS,” SERA KORR, KORR ORBITAL INDUSTRIES, DOMINIUM. EPN.)

Humanity has never lived through a finer age. People today can only dream of anything like it. The Father and the Mother gave us more than a thousand years of peace and prosperity. Every generation lived with a constant sense of improvement. Science, medicine, culture, the standard of living — progress showed up everywhere, in everything. Humanity claimed new worlds, reached the farthest edges of the star system, and started dreaming of the stars themselves.



**(MANIFEST OF THE EXECUTIVE COUNCIL,
DOMINIUM, YEAR 1647.)**

The Father and the Mother had decided to extend their time in cryosleep. From that point on, the Dawn Father and Mother would be chosen and guided by enlightened monks, who, through new technology, could sense the will of the Father and the Mother from within cryosleep.

3-6. BLACKOUT (YEAR 1648-2026)

In year 1648, the Father and the Mother of Dominium announced the Blackout for the good of all humanity. Civil war followed. That war produced the balance of power in the system today.



**(„THE BLACKOUT WAR: FROM INSURRECTION
TO EQUILIBRIUM,“ DR. STEFAN NAKAMURA, MERIDIAN
INSTITUTE FOR INDEPENDENT ANALYSIS,
HISTORICAL MONOGRAPH SERIES.)**

From the opening days of the Blackout War, organized resistance emerged in the Abyron Belt under the leadership of Protagen. Although headquartered on Erda, the corporation's principal assets were concentrated throughout the outer belt. During the early stage of the conflict, the fighting remained almost entirely confined to Dominium and Protagen. To outside observers, it resembled a military policing operation against an isolated insurgent movement. Contemporary assessments widely predicted a rapid victory, since few believed any force could sustain prolonged resistance against Dominium's military.

However, the war continued. Protagen suffered severe losses but continued fighting. The conflict revealed that space was far larger than either side had previously understood. Dominium expended enormous resources and time locating and destroying small but heavily armed stations and ships.

Protagon, meanwhile, identified a strategic vulnerability. Despite Erda's population, industrial capacity, and economic resources, the planet remained exposed to one of the simplest weapons available in space. The outer system contained an effectively limitless supply of asteroids. Redirecting even a relatively small body onto an impact trajectory required far fewer resources than defending against it.

Dominium devoted immense effort to detecting and intercepting thousands of these objects before they reached Erda. Even so, the occasional impact inflicted irreversible damage.

As the war dragged on, confidence in Dominium's central authority steadily weakened. The first sign appeared as quiet sabotage among the governments of stations and settlements located between Erda and the Abyron Belt. They did not want to become active participants in the conflict. Their priority was stability. Space-based infrastructure, particularly food distribution networks, was exceptionally fragile, and local administrations understood that even limited damage could have devastating consequences. Many, therefore, chose to remain on the sidelines.

Soon afterward, the first armed conflict between states on Erda in more than a thousand years followed. Once fighting resumed, it spread across the planet in a succession of regional wars, as humanity rediscovered interstate conflict after generations without it. Political movements also emerged that openly opposed both the Blackout policy and Dominium's central authority. Dominium's control deteriorated rapidly, both across the star system and on Erda itself.

To restore order, especially on Erda, Dominium returned to a strategy reminiscent of its earliest history by unveiling technologies that had remained hidden from the outside world. These included energy shielding and human cloning. Built upon those capabilities, Dominium raised a new military force and reestablished complete control over the planet.

Large armies of human clones did not carry the same military significance aboard orbital stations. Huoxing was the only exception, as it had an atmosphere, though not one humans could breathe.

By that point, the governments of many stations had already operated independently for some time. Fearing they would meet the same fate as the governments on Erda, they united in an alliance and established the Martian Democratic Republic, which became the strongest power in the star system outside Erda.

The war that began with the Blackout never formally ended. Its intensity declined over time as the balance of power between the major factions became increasingly stable. By the year 2026, the conflict had been reduced to small-scale local engagements between the factions.

* SECTION 4: DOMINIUM

Dominium is a theocratic empire that controls the only naturally habitable planet in the star system. Erda's population is approximately 50 billion, distributed across more than one hundred subordinate states.

Since year 1648, Dominium has enforced the Blackout policy — a system-wide prohibition on all communication and travel beyond the boundaries of the star system. External signals are actively suppressed, long-range detection technologies have been destroyed or placed under strict control, and any attempt to leave the system is treated as a fundamental violation of Dominium doctrine. This event shaped the modern balance of power throughout the star system. The Blackout marked the beginning of the conflict and the emergence of the factions.



(ADDRESS TO THE HOLY SYNOD REGARDING BLACKOUT POLICY. CASSIUS VALERIAN, MEMBER OF THE DOMINIUM EXECUTIVE COUNCIL.)

The Father and the Mother led our civilization to prosperity. They brought the endless bloodshed to a halt and taught us to live through creation. Under their guidance, we reached space, lived longer and happier lives, and achieved heights in science and art that had never before been imagined.

And what was on the other side of the scales? Without their firm and decisive intervention, humanity—and all life on our planet—would have perished in a nuclear war. Think about that. There would have been nothing left at all.

Back then, many refused to place their faith in the Father and the Mother. They went to war against them, just as many do today. Yet our saviors protected us then, and they are saving us now. The foolish do not understand that our star system is an island of life in a galaxy filled with death and horrors.







**(STATEMENT ON DOMINIUM INFORMATION CONTROL.
DEPUTY DIRECTOR, MOR REPUBLIC INFORMATION
DIRECTORATE, HUOXING.)**

Throughout its history, Dominion has sought complete and unquestioned control over the entire human race. For more than a thousand years, it succeeded. But no one can keep people locked in a gilded cage forever. When people began to realize that the stories of the Father and the Mother were nothing more than a tool for manipulation and control, Dominion devised another one: the Blackout policy.

Its purpose is simple: seize complete control of all communications and manipulate the population from a single center. Dominion introduced it at the very moment when its stories about the divine Father and Mother no longer inspired the obedience needed to preserve its rule.

Now that Dominion controls all satellite communications around Erda, it is able to shape the minds of the planet's fifty billion inhabitants. We fought for our freedom. Now we must free the people of Erda.



**(“THE BOTTLENECK ARGUMENT: WHY FEAR OF THE GALAXY
IS UNFOUNDED,” YENN LAO, BOARD MEMBER, PROTAGEN
CONFEDERAL COUNCIL.)**

The idea that space is full of "little green men" bent on conquering or exterminating humanity is nothing more than propaganda. It's an old method of holding onto power: invent an external enemy, portray it as a monstrous threat, and keep a fearful population under control.

Any civilization that reaches the level of technological development required to explore even its own nearby space must first pass through a bottleneck: the risk of self-destruction. A civilization that remains too aggressive after developing weapons of mass destruction will destroy itself in a nuclear war or some comparable conflict. Only those that are sufficiently rational and willing to coexist will survive. That is natural selection.

Besides, the galaxy is unimaginably vast, with countless planets capable of supporting life. If we ever encounter another intelligent species, it will be the most extraordinary event in the history of our civilization.



**(PRE-DEPLOYMENT LITANY, CUSTODIA SILENS.
PUBLISHED BY SACRED HERALD.)**

O Father, whose strength is our shield and whose resolve is our law. O Mother, whose love gives form and whose light gives life.

In the Dark Forest of the endless cosmos, You are the victory of life over death, of light over darkness, of love over hatred.

We thank You for the life and prosperity of billions — Your children, born under the light of Dominion.

Forgive us, for we have failed to bring all Your children into the light. Some among us still wander. Some mistake the void for freedom. Some hear the whisper of the Dark and call it knowledge. Some reach beyond Your embrace and offer their souls to the abominations that hunger in the outer dark.

Grant strength and courage to the best among us to stand against the apostates and to fulfill Your will.

Let prosperity and light be with all children of Erda who know the truth.

And may those who seek the darkness receive no mercy.

We are Dominion. We are the light.

Strength of the Father. Love of the Mother.
Until the stars fall silent.



* SECTION 5: PROTAGEN

Protagen is a corporation of Erdan origin that has resisted Dominion since the first days of the Blackout. It survived the war by exploiting the vast distances of the outer belt and relying on guerrilla warfare.

During the war, Protagen became a state by uniting the stations of the Abyron Belt. It also maintains a network of off-ecliptic stations and bases on the moons of Cassini.

Protagen's resources and population are limited, but it possesses a high level of technological development, particularly in military technology.



("OUR RIGHT TO THE GALAXY," KYUNG MORALES, CEO, HELION GENETICS, PROTAGEN. PRESS SERVICE INTERVIEW.)

We are the only truly rational society in the star system. We believe in scientific progress, the power of engineering, and the freedom of the individual. We alone stand against the ignorance spread by authoritarian regimes that keep people obedient through propaganda.

We defended our independence and our right to free speech during the Silence War, when Dominium sought to seize control of every means of communication and establish itself as the sole source of truth.

Humanity has already proven that science and ingenuity can overcome the harsh conditions of deep space. The galaxy holds countless worlds where we can live and prosper. The stars are within our reach, along with the opportunity to encounter other civilizations and learn even more. We can become an interstellar civilization. This is no dream. We know for certain that our current level of technology already makes it possible. What we lack are the resources held in abundance by the archaic governments of the inner planets.



("NO ONE COMES IF YOU CAN'T PAY," CAPTAIN TOMAS NG, MDR ICE HAULER. PERSONAL BLOG.)

Compared to us, Protagen is difficult to describe as a state. It is better understood as a confederation of stations and spacecraft operating under a common set of rules. Each station functions as its own microstate, with its own laws, social structure, and economic model. The central government is responsible for military and economic security. That creates an interesting contradiction: each station is free to govern itself until Protagen decides something has become a matter of collective security.

Once that happens, the authority of the central government is absolute. There are two reasons for this. First, the culture is built around the understanding that no one survives in this part of the star system without coordination. Second, refusing to comply brings immediate consequences. Imagine what happens to a station if its water deliveries are cut off, let alone if military force is used.

You might ask why Protagen grants its stations so much autonomy if it has the means to enforce its authority so completely. A centralized system would seem more logical. But freedom has another side of the coin: you are responsible for yourself.

Protagen operates on a simple principle: those who can survive, do; those who cannot, perish. The central government intervenes when supply chains are disrupted by accidents or other extraordinary events. But if a station runs short of oxygen because it cannot afford to buy more, Protagen does nothing.

That would be unthinkable in the MDR. Our government guarantees your basic rights and your security. It will do everything in its power to ensure you are never left to suffocate in the dark.





(LECTURE EXCERPT, DR. WEI DELACROIX, INSTITUTE OF
CONVERGENT BIOLOGY, STATION MERIDIAN. PROTAGEN.)

I've spent eighty years studying human adaptation to deep space. Eighty years, and I still remember the first time I reviewed a Marine's full biometric profile. I stopped halfway through. Not because something was wrong. Because nothing was. I just sat there. I don't think I'd ever seen anything like it.

Every Protagen Marine begins as a genetic architecture. Skeletal density, muscle composition, oxygen efficiency — all of it rewritten at the embryonic stage, before the child even takes its first breath.

That's only the blueprint, though. What comes after is decades of medical protocols, nutrition programs, developmental support. Year after year, making sure what was written into the genome actually shows up the way it was designed to. And the suit completes the body: life support, pressure containment, neural interface, built for this one body and no other.

(pause)

It is the most sophisticated convergence of biology and technology our civilization has produced. I do believe that.

(long pause)

But we should be honest about what it costs. You know this already — on stations across the Abyron Belt, children don't get the basic nutrients for normal skeletal formation. There are documented cases of irreversible cognitive damage in infants because the air on their station didn't carry enough oxygen. What goes into producing a single Marine could improve the lives of thousands instead.

And yet. Here it stands. A masterwork of science and engineering.
A Protagen Marine.

Programs like this are essential for our survival — and I want to be honest with you about why. The Blackout was never about protection. It was about control: who speaks, who listens, who's allowed to remember. Dominion turned silence into scripture, punishing anyone who questions it. We chose to question it anyway. That choice comes with consequences. Every Marine you see is one of them.

(voice steadies)

This is how we've always moved forward.

You're here to learn how to build what matters. Remember that every seat in this room was paid for with someone else's health.

* SECTION 6: MDR

The Martian Democratic Republic (MDR) is the largest state beyond Erda in both population and economic output. It was formed through the unification of most stations on Huoxing, the Kirkwood Belt, and the moons of Cassini.

MDR's political system is authoritarian. Martin rules the republic alongside a small elite composed of his own clones. The entire military establishment, from enlisted soldiers to senior generals, is made up entirely of clones. Each is the same individual inhabiting a different body, distinguished only by the life experience accumulated since the moment of cloning.





**(“FOUNDING OF THE MDR,” FREE SYSTEMS
ENCYCLOPEDIA, STATION KEPLER-FAR.)**

The union was established in 1689 at a congress of station governments held aboard Mars (the largest settlement in the Kirkwood Belt at the time) to coordinate a common defense against Dominion after it had reestablished full control over Erda by crushing the resistance with extreme brutality.

Although the stations had remained largely neutral during the war between Dominion and Protagen, they had every reason to believe Dominion would see that neutrality as betrayal and respond with reprisals. The congress established a governing council and granted Martin exclusive military authority for a one-year term.



* **MARTIN**



**(“A WEAPON THAT WALKED AWAY,” COLONEL ORIN DEY,
PROTAGEN MARINES. OFFICERS’ ASSEMBLY ADDRESS,
STATION FERRIS-3.)**

To understand who Martin is, you first need to understand how exactly Dominion won the war for Erda during the Silence War after declaring the Blackout.

Imagine you're trying to put down an uprising. Not just any uprising, but one led by people who sincerely believe they're fighting for their freedom, their right to choose, and, before long, for their own lives and the lives of those they love.

To crush a resistance like that, you need people who believe just as deeply in your cause — deeply enough to kill. Not just soldiers, but civilians who offer any form of resistance. And they have to do it effectively.

That's possible, of course. But first you have to find, train, convince, and prepare hundreds of thousands of people like that. Dominion already had such forces, but restoring order on a planet with a population of tens of billions required a rapid expansion of their ranks.

Now imagine you have cloning technology. Instead of finding hundreds of thousands of people willing to do it, you only need a few dozen of the most committed and capable ones. You don't even have to guess who will prove effective — just take those who have already demonstrated their loyalty, ruthlessness, and fanaticism across hundreds of battles, clone them, and build an army capable of pacifying entire continents. You never run out of them. Better still, the selection never stops: you keep choosing the "best" from among the "best."

Martin is one of them.



**(“THE HERO THEY TRIED TO ERASE,” MARICHKA ZHAO,
GOVERNING ADMINISTRATOR OF STATION MARS,
MOR. PUBLIC ADDRESS.)**

Our leader has every reason to hate Dominion and everything it stands for. During the Silence War, Martin was a loyal soldier—one of its most renowned and successful commanders. A hero of the war. By its final stages, nearly a third of all Silencer Brigades were made up of his clones.

Then came the betrayal. The very people Martin had believed were the light of humanity, the people he had fought and died for, turned on their own soldiers with cold, ruthless calculation. Once the war on Erda was won, the decision was made to eliminate them. Martin was among the few who survived. He watched those closest to him executed, along with countless copies of himself. No one understands the cruelty of Dominion's tyranny better than the man who lived through it.





[UNENCRYPTED MDR TRANSMISSION, ORIGIN: HUOXING.
INTERCEPTED BY CUSTODIA SILENS. REDISTRIBUTION
CARRIES CAPITAL SENTENCE.]

I remember everything.

I remember the war they built me for, the shield generators fused into my body, cooking me alive from the inside while I fought their enemies. I remember my brothers' skin burning black, and Dominium's command writing each death off as an acceptable loss.

I remember being copied without permission, simply because my body refused to die the way everyone else's did. I remember winning their war for them.

And I remember what came after — The Purification. Every daughter, every copy of my daughter, hunted down, burned, erased, deliberately, by policy. We remember it like it was yesterday. Because it is yesterday for every single one of us.

They thought the ashes of a discarded clone would just blow away in the dark, but they were wrong. On Huoxing, I found millions who knew they were next in line, so I gave them a wall to stand behind. They gave me a world in return.

Now I hold that world. I hold a fleet. I hold the memory of every daughter they burned and called it "peace."

This is not a threat. Threats are for men who haven't decided yet. This is a schedule.

— We are Martin.



(“THE CLONE WEAPON,” GENERAL DORIAN STEPANENKO, PRAEFECTURA MILITARIS DOMINIUM. ADDRESS TO SENIOR OFFICERS.)

The soldiers of the MDR Executive Unit use energy shields that allow them to fight without heavy armor while still having very effective protection against enemy fire. Every soldier is a clone of one version of Martin or another and carries the combat experience of that entire lineage, all the way back to its first battles during the Silence War. That means every Martin in the unit has a level of combat experience unmatched by anyone else in the system.

But their real advantage does not come from any individual soldier. It comes from the way they fight together. Each Martin knows the others... I would like to say as well as he knows himself. But that would not be accurate. Each of them is Martin. It is a team whose tactics and countless variations are carried out with exceptional precision.

The team's closeness is one factor. The other is selective breeding through cloning. When one unit proves more effective than the rest, it becomes the template for the next generation. From those copies, the best-performing unit is selected, and the process begins again. Each cycle produces a more capable lineage. They also maintain separate lineages for different combat conditions, selecting each one independently for its intended role.

This artificially guided natural selection has turned the MDR Executive Unit into an exceptionally effective and deadly weapon. As military professionals, we should treat such an opponent with the utmost seriousness.

* SECTION 7: ULFARI

**DOMINIUM SECURITY CHANCELLERY
INTERNAL ANALYSIS – FIRST CONTACT EVENT**

Classification: ABSOLUTE/Eyes Only

I. [VIGILIA EXTERIOR – SUBSECTION ABYSS]

Single visual capture obtained from confirmed asset within Protagen logistics network.
Source vessel: Erebus-7, decommissioned deep-range carrier, far-orbit position
outside ecliptic.

Image depicts four (4) Protagen crew in direct proximity to a single unidentified
biological entity. Non-hostile posture on both sides. No weapons raised.

Image authenticated through four independent protocols.
Synthetic generation ruled out.



II. [COLLEGIUM OF BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES - MILITARY ANALYSIS DIVISION]

Entity is broadly humanoid. Bipedal, bilaterally symmetrical.
Critical divergences from human baseline:

Cranial structure and facial geometry deviate significantly from human morphological range. Skull proportions do not correspond to any known human phenotype or documented developmental variation.

Multiple functional tentacle-like appendages originating from upper back and cervical region. Structures appear muscularized, prehensile, and independently mobile. No analog in human anatomy, not consistent with any documented gene modification pathway, including Protagen advanced programs.

Suit and equipment design conform to no known system manufacturer.
Material composition, surface structure, and integration principles are unidentifiable from visual analysis.

Conclusion: Degree of biological divergence rules out modified human origin.
High-confidence assessment: extra-system organisms.

III. [DR. ALDRIC SORENTUS - OFFICE OF DOCTRINAL STRATEGY - SENIOR ADVISORY MEMORANDUM]

The entire architecture of Blackout rests on a single foundational claim: that the space beyond our system boundary is hostile, contact means annihilation, and isolation is the price of survival. Every institution we have built, every doctrine we have enforced, every judgment we have carried out in the name of sacred silence derive their legitimacy from that premise.

If this information becomes public, the following consequences are immediate and irreversible:

Protagen is retroactively vindicated.
Their position stops being an ideology and becomes a documented fact.

MDR gains moral leverage to claim Blackout was always an instrument of control.

The internal doctrinal framework — fifty billion people raised on the premise that the cosmos is hostile — suffers irreversible collapse.

I want to be precise: this is not a military or economic threat. This is an existential threat to the ideological foundation of Dominium itself. If Blackout falls, everything built on top of it falls with it.

IV. [OFFICIUM QUIETIS - OPERATIONAL PLANNING CELL]

Proposed immediate countermeasures. Combined effect: Multi-layered noise environment.

1. Release fabricated alien contact materials, leaked classified documents, secret weapons program exposés, and other unverifiable claims through 30+ proxy channels. Vary quality. Simultaneously activate controlled independent assets to publicly debunk them. Objective: Condition the public to associate any contact claim with fraud before authentic material surfaces.

2. Initiate food security concern narratives through Prefectorial channels in 4+ agricultural districts. Sufficient alarm to dominate public discourse for 2-3 weeks minimum.

3. Activate dormant provocation assets in at least two geographically separated regions. Escalate existing social or ethnic tensions to a visible conflict level. Must appear organic.

V. [TRIBUNAL OF SACRED ORDER - EMERGENCY OPERATIONAL DIRECTIVE]

Nearest Custodia Silens detachment: Deploy immediately to coordinates of Erebus-7.

Primary: Eliminate all witnesses, human and non-human.
Destroy all data, logs, recordings. The event never occurred.

Contingency: If non-human entity cannot be neutralized, engage with maximum hostility. Ensure that any subsequent contact between extra-system forces and system populations begins as active conflict.



(“BEYOND MECHANICS,” DR. SLAWA ERIKSON, BIOMECHANICAL RESEARCH LEAD, PROTAGEN SCIENCE DIRECTORATE. PERSONAL RESEARCH BLOG.)

I admire them. The more I study their technology, the more amazed I become. We are still trying to solve problems with mechanical engineering, building machines from non-living materials that eventually wear out and have to be repaired. They engineer living matter itself. While we measure our factories in square kilometers, they build theirs inside living cells. Their technology grows, reproduces, and repairs itself.

I dare to suggest that this is the minimum level of technology any civilization needs before it can operate on a galactic scale. Anything built on pure mechanics alone is too primitive to carry a species into space.



**("ULFARI COMBAT PROFILE," GENERAL MIKHAI WOLFF,
PRAEFECTURA MILITARIS DOMINIUM. CLASSIFIED
BRIEFING TO SENIOR OFFICERS.)**

Based on the information currently available to us, Ulfari appear to rely primarily on the skill of each individual warrior. Every individual displays a distinct fighting style. Personal initiative seems to take priority over coordinated teamwork, although they cooperate effectively when required. At times, they appear to be competing with one another for dominance within the group.

Their combat style is aggressive and highly offensive. They move quickly and close to melee range whenever the opportunity presents itself. In low gravity or zero gravity, they make full use of three-dimensional space, unconstrained by the conventional concepts of up and down. They leap, push off, and maneuver from every available surface. They also display extreme brutality toward defeated opponents.



**("IF I HAD THEIR TECHNOLOGY," MIRA TANAKA,
POPULAR SCIENCE WRITER, PROTAGEN.
PERSONAL JOURNAL.)**

We still don't know how life first appeared in our star system, whether it emerged naturally during the early history of one of our planets, or arrived from elsewhere in the galaxy. We do know, however, that microorganisms can travel naturally from one planet to another within a single star system. But for those organisms to drift across hundreds or thousands of light-years by chance, surviving the journey intact—that is either impossible or extraordinarily unlikely.

Now imagine a civilization with the technology—and the ambition—to send tiny self-replicating machines across interstellar distances. Machines capable of reproducing themselves and constructing whatever is needed once they arrive. Looking at the Ulfari, I can't help thinking that only a civilization with this level of bioengineering could accomplish something like that. Such machines would have to be built on the principles of living biology, not conventional mechanical engineering.

If I possessed technology like that, together with enough altruism and a desire to see intelligent life emerge in distant corners of the universe, I would send self-replicating organisms in every direction. I don't know if the Ulfari are altruists with dreams like that. But I do believe their technology makes it possible.



["WHAT MADE THEM THIS WAY," PRIYA CHEN, MDR ANTHROPOLOGIST. PUBLISHED IN REPUBLIC ACADEMIC REVIEW.]

The Ulfari's predatory psychology may be the result of the intensely competitive environment in which they evolved, survived, and, by all appearances, flourished. We have no experience interacting with civilizations beyond our own star system. It's entirely possible that, from another civilization's perspective, human culture would also appear exceptionally warlike.

We don't know what made the Ulfari what they are. But I believe every culture is shaped by its circumstances, by the environment in which it develops. Their aggressiveness, combined with their level of technological advancement, suggests the Ulfari responded successfully to those conditions. That suggests there are places beyond our star system that would seem unimaginably harsh by our standards.



["UNITE OR PERISH," CASSIUS VALERIAN, MEMBER OF THE DOMINIUM EXECUTIVE COUNCIL. EMERGENCY ADDRESS, ALL FREQUENCIES.]

They are predatory creatures from the Dark Forest of space. We built our civilization to protect humanity—and life itself—from evils like these. If you think they are the worst humanity could ever face, have faith: these Ulfari may one day seem almost gentle by comparison. At least they are humanoid beings, driven to savagery by the brutal conditions of the Dark Forest. Imagine what else may be hiding there.

For thousands of years, the Father and the Mother have guided humanity toward prosperity while shielding us from the horrors beyond the darkness. Now is the time for all humanity to unite under the protection of Dominion, destroy the vile creatures that have entered our home, and continue to keep the Silence.

* SECTION 8: TACTICAL APPLICATION

8-1. Tactical proficiency is not developed through study alone. Everything you have absorbed in Sections 2 through 7 gives you the context to understand the theatre.

All practical instruction required for field execution and squad-level command is issued as a direct supplement to this publication, in the accompanying volume:

THE WARCODE TACTICAL DOCTRINE: RULEBOOK.

THE WARCODE. TACTICAL DOCTRINE: FIELD EDITION "LOREBOOK"
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